2023年12月四级真题第2套

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听力原文 / Transcripts

新闻听力原文 / News Report（英文）

College English Test, Band 4, Part 2, Listening Comprehension, Section A, Directions. In this section, you will hear three news reports. At the end of each news report, you will hear two or three questions. Both the news report and the questions will be spoken only once.
After you hear a question, you must choose the best answer from the four choices marked
A, B, C, and D. Then mark the corresponding letter on answer sheet 1 with a single line
through the center.
News reports 1. A police officer in the US stopped a large SUV car that was going very
slowly and drifting across lanes on a highway. He expected to find a driver who
was either very drunk or having a medical emergency. Instead, the officer discovered a five-year-old
boy sat on the edge of the driver's seat. His feet could barely reach the break, and
his head was only just high enough to see out of the windows. The child had taken the keys
to the family car while his teenage sister was napping. He then drove three kilometers
across town before getting on the highway. The boy later told confused officers that he
was planning to travel to California and by a Lamborghini sports car. Although he only
had three dollars in his wallet, at least he was driving in the right direction.
Questions 1 and 2 are based on the news report you have just heard?
Question 1. Why did the police officer stop the SUV car?
Question 2. What did the boy tell the police officers he was planning to do?
News Report 2 Mobile phones have changed the way we live, how we read, work, communicate,
and shop. But we already know this. What we have not yet understood is the way that
Many machines in front of us are changing our skeletons. Possibly altering not just the
way we behave, but even the very shape of our bodies.
New scientific research at the University of the Sunshine Coast in Queensland, Australia,
suggests that young people are developing extra pieces of bone at the backs of their heads.
These pieces of bone are caused by the way people bend their heads when they use the
This shifts weight onto the muscles at the back of the head and causes the bone to grow
in a way that is not normal. This process can be compared to the way the skin heartens
in response to constant rubbing or pressure. The result is a piece of bone like a horn
that sticks out from the head by the neck.
Question 3 and 4 are based on the news report you have just heard.
Question 3.
What does the report say we have not yet understood about mobile phones?
Question 4. What happens to the skin when rubbed or pressed constantly?
New Report 3 A village is going to throw a birthday party for an orange cat's named Wilbur,
who has become famous for making a regular appearance at local shops. Wilbur has his own internet
pages as he approaches his tenth birthday on July 7. Wilbur is both bold and friendly.
He spends most of his time in shops and businesses around the village, he'll just take
himself into any shop anywhere. There was one time when the doctors receptionist came
back and he was sitting on her chair. Among his favourite haunts are a local hairdresser,
two pubs, and the knotting and primary school.
Leslie Harper, who runs one of the pubs, said the cat has been a big hit with their
He's been a regular visitor for most of this year, she told the press association.
He's a very relaxed cat, happy for customers and villagers young and old to come in and
say hello.
She also said he is a cat of expensive tastes, who likes his high priced cat food.
Sarah Godfrey, who is organizing Wilbur's party, told the local newspaper, Wilbur is part
our lives as he is for everyone who lives in the village.
Question 6. What do we learn from the report about the cat?
Question 7. What does the pub owner Leslie Harper say about the cat?

长对话听力原文 / Conversations（英文）

Section B, Directions. In this section you will hear two long conversations. At the end of each conversation, you will hear four questions. Both the conversation and the questions will be spoken only once.
After you hear a question, you must choose the best answer from the four choices, marked
A, B, C, and D. Then, mark the corresponding letter on answer sheet 1 with a single line
through the center. Conversation 1.
So, where do you want to go for lunch?
I don't know. Do you have anything in mind?
What about the sandwich place on Camden Street?
Hmm,no, sorry. I don't feel like sandwiches today. It's a great place, but I think we go there too often.
That's true. Remember that's where we saw Bridget Clark, the famous movie star.
Of course, how could I ever forget? There were crowds of people around her asking for a photo with her.
What about Hamburg, is then? Does that American style diner on the way to the mall?
I like that place. Their chips are great, but their service takes a long time, and I need
to get back by 230 for a conference call. How about trying something new? We could try
Mario's, the new Italian restaurant on the corner. It looks alright. Have you been there?
No, I haven't, but I've noticed that it has great reviews on the internet. It's supposed
to be one of the best Italians in town. I think Jeremy has been there, and said it was amazing.
I'm up for that.
Cool. Have you asked Jeremy if he would like to come with us?
I already have. He says he can't. He has brought his own lunch today, so he will stay in.
I think his wife made him soup.
Poor Jeremy. His wife is a terrible cook. He should throw that soup in the bin and join us.
Questions 8 to 11 are based on the conversation you have just heard.
Question 8. What's are the speakers talking about in this conversation?
Question 9. Where did the speakers see Bridget Clark the famous movie star?
Question 10. Why does the woman say she needs to get back by 230?
Question 11. Why does the woman say Jeremy should throw his soup in the bin?
Conversation 2
Hi there, how are you today? Do you have a reservation with us already?
Good afternoon! Yes! We reserved our rooms yesterday morning on your website for 3 nights, the names Patterson.
Okay, let me have a look. Yes, we have it here. You brought the whole family with you, I see.
Yes, the two kids my wife and I, and her parents too.
Great.
So we have a family room for you and your wife and the kids, and another double room for
your parents and law.
They are right next to each other on the ground floor, since you mentioned in your
message that they have trouble with stairs.
That's wonderful.
My father-in-law has had terrible problems getting up and down stairs since his new operation
last April.
I'm sorry to hear that, and if you need any help to find transportation for the whole family,
we can definitely recommend someone for you.
We were thinking of renting a car, but we will explore all the options available for sure.
So yes, that would be very helpful in comparing prices.
We're also wondering what tours and day trips are available.
We have a bunches of brochures here.
I would recommend getting out on a boat trip.
The kids will love it, and there are so many islands nearby to explore.
There's also a great night market for their into town that has all kinds of food and cool little shops,
selling souvenirs and local jewelry, and clothing made by hand.
That all sounds marvelous.
Now all I need is to photocopy your passports, and then I can get you all checked in and show you to your rooms.
Questions 12 to 15 are based on the conversation you have just heard.
Question 12 Who is the man talking to in the conversation?
Question 13. What do we learn about the man's father-in-law from the conversation?
Question 14. Why does the man say they will explore all the options available?
Question 15. What does the woman suggest the man and his family do close to the end of
the conversation?

听力篇章原文 / Passages（英文）

Section C, directions. In this section you will hear three passages. At the end of each passage you will hear three or four questions. Both the passage and the questions will be spoken only once.
After you hear a question, you must choose the best answer from the four choices marked
A, B, C and D. Then mark the corresponding letter on Ansuchit 1 with a single line through
the center.
Passage 1. Artificial intelligence agents play ever more influential roles in our lives.
They do everything from suggesting new friends to recommending purchases.
They're even beginning to drive our cars.
Another role that they are expected to take over is negotiating on our behalf in commercial transactions or legal disputes.
So, it's important to know whether using an artificial intelligence agent might affect how we negotiate.
Research indicates that it does.
In a new study, participants were told to imagine that they were negotiating for something
important to them, like a house.
Next, they were told either that they would negotiate for themselves, or they would program
an artificial intelligence agent to negotiate for them.
Participants then completed a survey, indicating how tough, deceptive, and pleasant or otherwise
they wanted to be.
or one of their agent to be in the negotiations.
For example, participants could choose to be tough by making an opening demand far greater than what they'd be willing to accept.
They could also choose to express sympathy with their opponent to appear pleasant.
But they could also indicate that day or their agent would strategically express anger toward the opponent to gain advantage.
or they could opt to convey dissatisfaction with the encounter so that the other party
would think they were losing interest. These are both examples of deceptive strategies.
Participants were more willing to employ deceptive strategies when assigned an agent to
negotiate on their behalf. Questions 16 to 18 are based on the passage you have just heard.
Question 16. What does the passive say about artificial intelligence agents?
Question 17. What does the new study want to find out about using an artificial intelligence
agents.
Question 18. What did participants tend to do when assigned an AI agent to negotiate
on their behalf.
Passage 2
New research has studied the effects of a seven week healthy cooking course.
Acid anics measured the program's effect on cooking confidence and self-proceed mental
health.
Researchers also measured participants overall satisfaction around cooking and diet related
behaviours. What were the findings?
Course participants saw significance improvements in general health. They also reported improved
mental health and subjective vitality immediately after the program. These benefits remained
six months after the completion of the course.
What caused these improvements? Researchers have previously found a link between eating more fruits
and vegetables and improved longer-term mental health. This would imply that the participants
in the current study may have felt better due to improved diet. However, the study showed
participants mental health improved even if their reported diets did not change after
completing the program. Also, the mental health benefits were equal among participants who
are overweight or obese and those in a healthy weight range. This suggests a link between
cooking confidence and satisfaction around cooking and mental health benefits.
Who benefits most from learning to cook? Gender plays a part. At the start of the program,
77% of female participants were confident about cooking, but just 23% of males were confident.
At the end of the program, cooking confidence and skills were equal across both counterparts.
This changing confidence could lead to a gender balance in home cooking.
This in turn could reduce consumption of unhealthy high calorie processed meals.
Question 19. Question 19. Question 19. What do we learn about the benefits the participants gained from the healthy cooking course?
Question 20. What do the new research findings suggest about mental health benefits?
Question 21. What plays a role in determining who benefits most from learning to cook?
Passage 3 What is personal space?
We often think of it as an invisible bubble of space surrounding us that others can't
enter without causing discomfort.
Research shows, however, that we actually have bubbles of different sizes.
Each of these bubbles applies to a different set of people.
The smallest zone, called intimate space, extends outward from our bodies, 18 inches in every
direction.
Only family, pets, and one's closest friends may enter it.
Amir acquaintance entering our intimate space makes us uncomfortable.
Next is the bubble called personal space, extending from 1.5 feet to 4 feet away.
Friends and acquaintances can comfortably occupy this zone, especially during informal conversations,
but strangers are forbidden.
Extending from 4 to 12 feet away from us is social space.
Here people feel comfortable conducting routine social interactions with new acquaintances
or total strangers.
Those are the average sizes of Americans' personal bubbles, anyway.
It is important to keep in mind that personal space varies depending on culture and context.
Furthermore, there are significant individual differences. As we all know, cultural or individual
differences in personal bubble diameters are all too often the cause of discomfort.
How do these personal bubbles arise? According to research, we begin to develop our individual
sense of personal space around age 3 or 4. The sizes of our bubbles are fixed by our
These bubbles are constructed and monitored by the brain region involved in fear.
Questions 22-25 are based on the passage you have just heard.
Question 22.
What does research show about our personal space?
Question 23 What happens if a mere acquaintance enters our intimate space?
Question 24. Where the people feel comfortable interacting with new acquaintances or
strangers.
Question 25 When are the sizes of our bubbles fixed?
That's the end of listening comprehension.